

SENATE JOINT RESOLUTION 966

By Massey

A RESOLUTION to commend and honor CASA of East Tennessee on the occasion of its fortieth anniversary.

WHEREAS, it is fitting that the members of this General Assembly should salute those worthy organizations that are dedicated to improving the lives of children and families; and

WHEREAS, one such noteworthy organization is CASA of East Tennessee, which is celebrating its fortieth anniversary of operation in 2026; and

WHEREAS, CASA's vision is that every abused and neglected child is given the opportunity to thrive in a safe and loving home; the organization carries out this vision with trained volunteers who advocate for these children, empowering them to express their concerns and fears, as well as their hopes and dreams, and to be heard by their families and the court; and

WHEREAS, since its establishment in Knox County in 1986, CASA has intervened to represent the best interests of each child it serves; the Knox County Juvenile Court relies on CASA to provide detailed information regarding every aspect of a child's life in order to aid in making the best possible decision regarding placement and needed services; and

WHEREAS, the court routinely accepts ninety-seven percent of CASA's recommendations regarding placement and essential services, and six months after case closure, ninety-nine percent of children served remain in permanent homes; in 2025, of the 146 children whose cases closed, 142 were successfully reunified with parents, placed with kin, or adopted; and

WHEREAS, this fiscal year, CASA of East Tennessee has seen a remarkable surge in community impact, powered by fifty-three active volunteers, up from thirty-nine volunteers the

previous year; these dedicated advocates have already donated 1,870 hours of service, reaching 172 children, up from 128 the previous year; and

WHEREAS, for four decades, CASA of East Tennessee has worked daily to fulfill its mission to improve the lives of abused and neglected children through trained volunteers who advocate for a safe, permanent, loving home; and

WHEREAS, the well-being and safety of our children are of paramount importance to our future, and it is fitting that we should recognize and honor CASA of East Tennessee and its volunteers for their extraordinary dedication to helping the children of our State; now, therefore,

BE IT RESOLVED BY THE SENATE OF THE ONE HUNDRED FOURTEENTH GENERAL ASSEMBLY OF THE STATE OF TENNESSEE, THE HOUSE OF REPRESENTATIVES CONCURRING, that we honor and congratulate CASA of East Tennessee upon the occasion of its fortieth anniversary and commend the volunteers for their ongoing commitment to providing outstanding services to Tennessee's children.

BE IT FURTHER RESOLVED, that an appropriate copy of this resolution be prepared for presentation with this final clause omitted from such copy and upon proper request made to the appropriate clerk, the language appearing immediately following the State seal appear without House or Senate designation.